



Mastercoin leverages the active Bitcoin network to create new services and currency systems.

Mastercoin also uses the protocol to work as price feeds that can update and inform users of prices of various goods and commodities through the scripts. Along with these commercially finance features, Mastercoin is also able register speculative trades or bets between

people based on the value of the coin itself in a “price spread” style which allows financial hedging and arbitrage with lower levels of currency risk and volatility.

Primecoin

Primecoin is created by the same person as Peercoin, Sunny King, who employs a different proof-of-work system for this cryptocurrency. Primecoin is based on the same principles as Bitcoin except its mining efforts are based on searches for chains of prime numbers. Using this cryptographic technique disallows GPUs from participating in mining efforts.

The key variations from Bitcoin are that the computational efforts invested for Bitcoin’s hashcash proof-of-work system do not provide any other value beyond the creation of Bitcoins. With Primecoin’s system of prime search proof-of-work the combined computational power of mining results in the discovery of long Cunningham chains of prime numbers that are of significant interest to the academic and scientific community. Already this system has resulted in the discovery of long Cunningham chains.

Another benefit of Primecoin is its faster block creation time which is 1 new block per minute as compared to Bitcoin’s 1 new block every 10 minutes. Due to this faster block creation, the resulting Primecoin transactions are also 10 times as fast however the difficulty on the Primecoin protocol is adjusted with everyblock as compared to Bitcoin’s 2016 blocks. Along